

Nielsen Norman Group **Heuristic Evaluation Workbook**

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

No visible confirmation after editing profile (e.g., "Saved successfully").

Edit icon is small and not very noticeable.

Recommendations

Add success feedback (toast/snackbar).

Highlight active states (e.g., when editing fields).

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

Some labels like "Nickname" may not be necessary in a medical context.

"State" dropdown shows unrelated options (e.g., Melbourne mixed with countries).

Recommendations

Use real-world medical/account terms (e.g., "Full Name," "Contact Number").

Fix dropdown structure (Country → State → City hierarchy).

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3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

No clear "Cancel" button in Edit Profile

Navigation relies mainly on back arrow.

Recommendations

Add "Cancel" and "Save" buttons.

Allow undo for critical edits.

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

Inconsistent spacing and alignment of input fields. Icons and text styles vary slightly. Dropdown styles differ from input fields.

Recommendations

Standardize padding, font sizes, and field styles.

Use consistent icon style and placement.

Follow platform UI guidelines (Android/iOS).

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Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

No input validation shown (e.g., phone number format).

No constraints on fields (email, phone, etc.).

Recommendations

Add input validation (real-time).

Use field constraints (e.g., numeric keypad for phone).

Provide confirmation for sensitive changes.

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

Labels inside fields disappear when typing (hard to recall).

No helper text or hints.

Recommendations

Use floating labels (stay visible).

Add placeholder hints (e.g., "Enter valid email").

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Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

No shortcuts or autofill options.

No integration with saved data (e.g., previous addresses).

Recommendations

Enable autofill for common fields.

Add quick-select options (e.g., saved addresses).

Allow profile picture quick edit.

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

Some redundancy in fields (e.g., multiple "Name" placeholders in components panel).

Slight clutter in profile screen (many menu items without grouping).

Recommendations

Group related items (Orders, Prescriptions, Payments).
Reduce visual noise.

Keep only essential information.

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Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

No visible error messages.

No guidance when input is wrong

Recommendations

Show inline error messages (e.g., "Invalid email").

Use color indicators (red text, icons).

Suggest fixes clearly.

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

No help or guidance visible.

No tooltip or info icons.

Recommendations

Add help icon or FAQ section.

Provide tooltips for unclear fields.

Include onboarding hints for first-time users.